

GLOBAL
EDITION



Marketing Research

An Applied Orientation

SEVENTH EDITION

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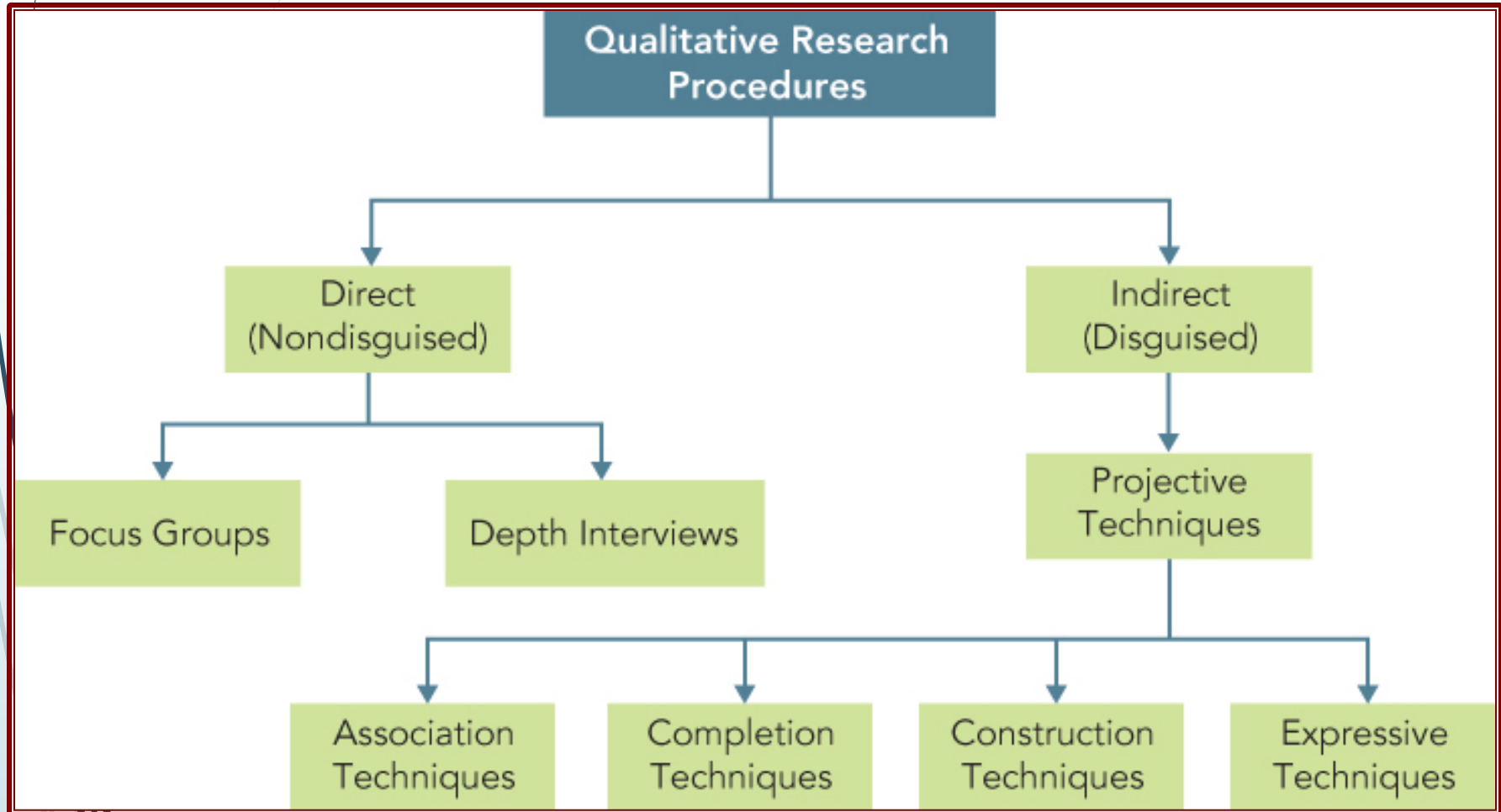


Chapter 5:

Exploratory Research Design: Qualitative Research

Continued

Classification of Qualitative Research Procedures



(2) Interviews



Characteristics of Personal Interviews

- ➡ No other skill is as important to the research worker as the ability to conduct good interviews.
- ➡ Interview, unlike most other techniques, requires interpersonal skills of a high order:
 - ➡ Takes from 30 minutes to more than one hour,
 - ➡ Putting the respondent at ease,
 - ➡ Take notes without upsetting the conversational flow,
 - ➡ **Giving support without introducing bias (1 to 1).**
- ➡ They are essentially of two kinds:
 - ➡ Unstructured (Exploratory or Depth) Interviews
 - ➡ Structured (Standardized) Interviews

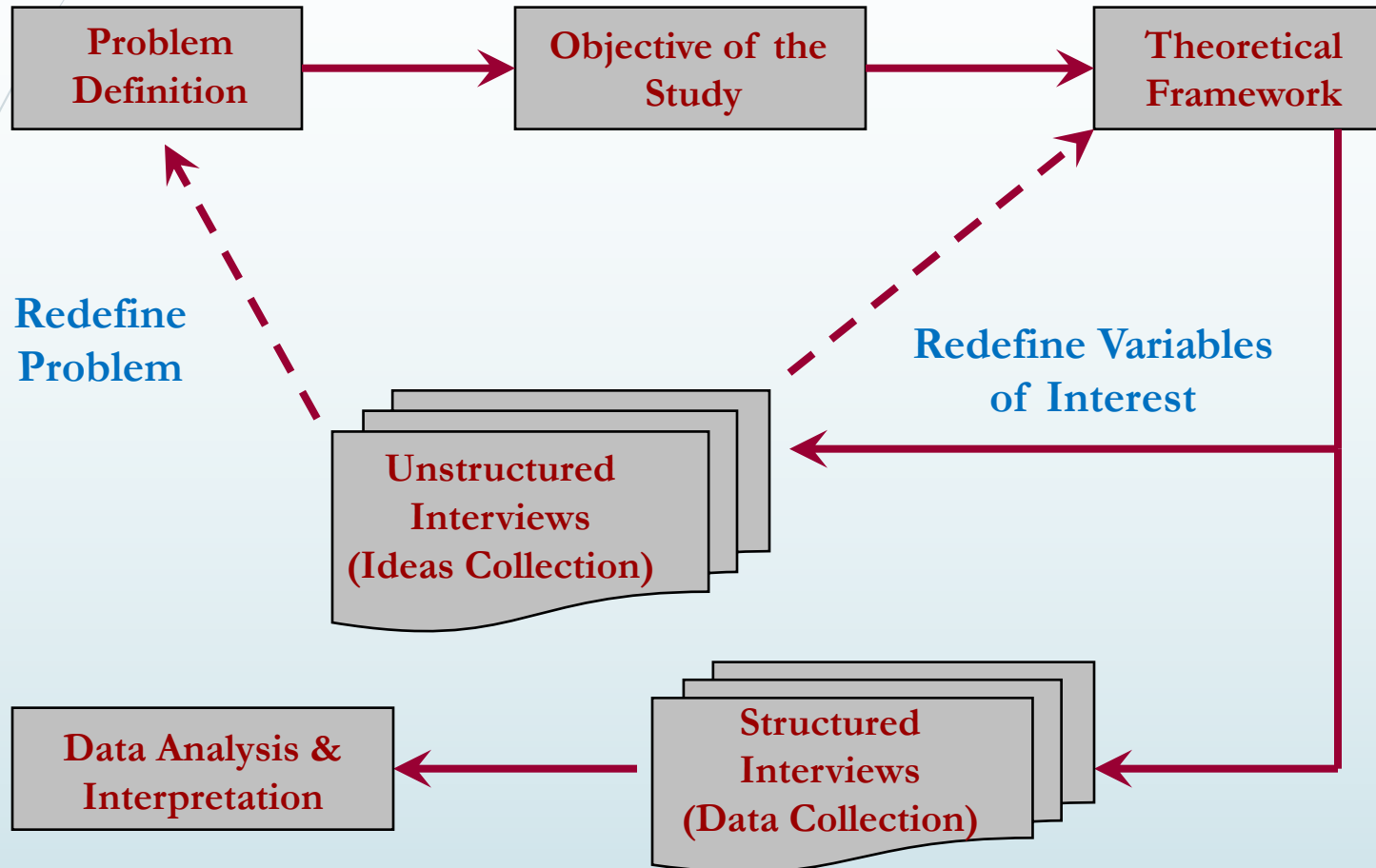
Unstructured (Depth) Interviews

- ➡ **Unstructured interviews** are so labeled because the interviewer does not enter the interview setting with a planned sequence of questions to be asked to the respondent. **The objective of this type of interviews is to uncover underlying ideas, motivations, beliefs on topic.**
- ➡ Thus, depth interviews help in the formulation of the research problem, collect ideas and improve the conceptualization of research questions and articulation of hypotheses, based on **“Hidden Agenda”** of the researcher.
- ➡ The **Hidden Agenda** is only hidden in the sense that it should not be too obvious to the respondent. The interview should move naturally from topic to topic, and the interviewer may start with any of the topics on the Agenda and proceed in any order.
- ➡ **No fixed questions.** Every effort is made to get respondents to express their own ideas spontaneously in their own words.

Structured Interviews

- ➡ **Structured interviews** are those conducted when it is known what information is needed. The interviewer has a list of **predetermined questions to be posed to the respondents.**
- ➡ The same questions are asked to everybody in the same order as in the **interview protocol.**
- ➡ At this point of research process, the interviewer does not have the luxury of initiating new topics, adding new questions, or even following up interesting ideas. You should be bound by the requirement of **Stimulus Equivalence.**
- ➡ Interviewer should be able to distinguish two types of questions:
 - ➡ **Factual Questions**, where he/she is expected to read out the question as printed, but can offer explanations.
 - ➡ **Non-Factual Questions (Opinions/Behaviors)**, in which interviewers are forbidden to explain or reword in any way.

Unstructured Vs. Structured Interviews



Interviews Vs. Focus Groups

Characteristic	Focus Groups	Interviews
Group synergy and dynamics	+	-
Peer pressure/group influence	-	+
Generation of innovative ideas	+	-
In-depth probing of individuals	-	+
Discussion of sensitive topics	-	+
Interviewing respondents who are competitors	-	+
Scheduling of respondents	-	+
Amount of information	+	-
Cost per respondent	+	-
Time (interviewing and analysis)	+	-

(3) Projective Techniques



Understanding Projective Techniques

- An unstructured and indirect form of questioning that encourages the respondents to project their underlying motivations, beliefs, or attitudes regarding the issues of concern.
- In these techniques, respondents are asked to interpret the behavior of the others rather than describing their own behavior. In interpreting the other's behavior, respondents indirectly project their own attitudes or feelings into the situation.
- Projective techniques should be used when the required information cannot be accurately obtained by direct methods.
- **There are 3 techniques:**
 - **Word Associations**
 - **Completion Techniques**
 - **Construction Techniques**

Word Association

- In word association, respondents are presented with a list of words, one at a time, and asked to respond to each with the first word that comes to mind.
- The words of interest, called test words, are interspersed throughout the list which also contains some neutral, or filler words to disguise the purpose of the study.
- **Example:** Word Association was used by **P&G** to study women's attitudes toward detergents. Below is a list of stimulus words used and the responses of two women of similar age and household status.
- The set of responses are quite different, suggesting that the women differ in personality and in their attitudes toward housekeeping.

Word Association: An Example



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<u>STIMULUS</u>	<u>MRS. M</u>	<u>MRS. C</u>
washday	everyday	ironing
fresh	and sweet	clean
pure	air	soiled
scrub	don't; husband does	clean
filth	this neighborhood	dirt
bubbles	bath	soap and water
family	squabbles	children
towels	dirty	wash

Word Association: Analyzing Responses

- Customer responses can be analyzed based on:
 - (1) the frequency with which any word is given as a response;
 - (2) the amount of time that elapses before a response is given;
 - (3) the number of respondents who do not respond at all to a test word within a reasonable period of time.
- These findings suggest that the market for detergents could be segmented on the basis of attitudes towards cloth washing.
- Procter & Gamble has positioned different brands of detergents (Tide, Ariel, Bounux, Downy, Powder Vs. Gel) for different attitudinal segments, as revealed by word associations.

Completion Techniques

➤ In **sentence completion**, respondents are given incomplete sentences and are asked to complete them. Generally, they are asked to use the first word or phrase that comes to mind.

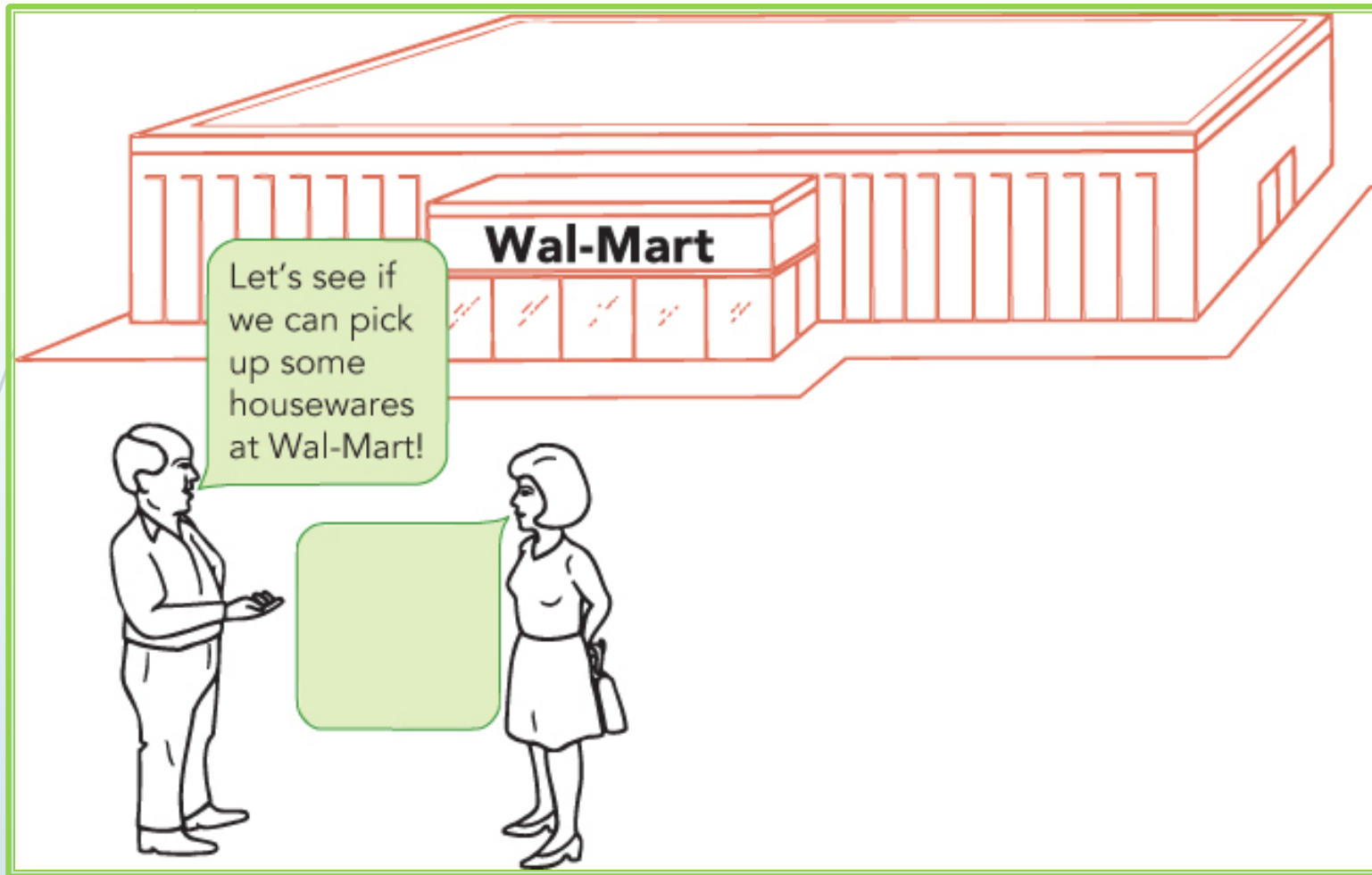
➤ **Examples:**

- 1) A person who shops at Moda Mall is _____
- 2) A person who receives a gift certificate good for Saks Fifth Avenue would be _____
- 3) Lulu Market is most liked by _____
- 4) When I think of shopping in a department store, I _____

Construction Techniques

- With a **picture response**, the respondents are asked to describe a series of pictures of ordinary as well as unusual events.
- The respondent's interpretation of the pictures gives indications of that individual's personality.
- In **cartoon tests**, cartoon characters are shown in a specific situation related to the marketing problem. The respondents are asked to indicate what one cartoon character might say in response to the comments of another character.
- Cartoon tests are simpler to administer and analyze than picture response techniques.

A Cartoon Test



Advantages of Projective Techniques

- They may elicit responses that customers would be unwilling or unable to give if they knew the purpose of the study.
- Helpful when the issues to be addressed are personal, sensitive, or subject to strong social norms.
- Helpful when underlying motivations, beliefs, and attitudes are operating at a subconscious level.

Disadvantages of Projective Techniques

- Suffer from many of the disadvantages of unstructured direct techniques, but to a greater extent.
- Require highly-trained interviewers.
- There is a serious risk of interpretation bias.
- They tend to be expensive.
- May require respondents to engage in unusual behavior.